PROOFS FOR THE EXISTENCE OF GOD AND THEIR CRITIQUE

PROOF-FORCE AND THREE TIERS → A PRIORI / A POSTERIORI → ONTOLOGICAL ARGUMENT → ONTOLOGICAL CRITIQUE → COSMOLOGICAL FAMILY → THE FIVE WAYS → THREE TELEOLOGIES → HUME AND DARWIN → MORAL ROUTES → NYĀYA-UDAYANA → FOUR INDIAN DENIALS → CUMULATIVE CASE → SYNTHESIS AND ANSWER SPINE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW | ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA | ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • repaired in place; all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 PROOF-FORCE, BURDEN AND THE THREE TIERS OF ASSESSMENT

VALIDITY | SOUNDNESS | ADEQUACY | DEDUCTION vs PROBABILITY vs POSTULATE | BURDEN SPLITS THREE WAYS | A GAP IS NOT EVIDENCE | PASCAL'S WAGER IS NOT A PROOF | SYLLABUS ITEM 2, PAPER II

THE THREE SEPARATE VERDICTS

- VALIDITY: granted the premises, does the conclusion follow?
- SOUNDNESS: are the premises true? This is where the canonical critics attack.
- ADEQUACY: is the being reached one, necessary, personal, perfectly good and worship-worthy? This is Kant's conclusion-gap.

SIX GRADES OF CLAIMED FORCE

- Deductive: Anselm's reductio and some cosmological reconstructions.
- Inductive or abductive: design, fine-tuning and inference to the best explanation.
- Cumulative: Udayana's collected grounds; Swinburne's confirmation programme.
- Practical postulate: Kant, explicitly not theoretical knowledge.
- Explanatory termination: Leibniz's principle of sufficient reason.

BURDEN AND LIMITS

- The proponent must defend the starting premise, the inference and the theological identification separately.
- A finite explanatory gap is not itself evidence for God: 'science has not explained X, therefore God' is not an argument.
- Allowing the contingent totality to be a brute fact rejects sufficient reason; it does not refute the cosmological argument.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Most scripts answer only the validity question, and therefore forfeit the marks reserved for premise-truth and for the adequacy of the God actually reached.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The word proof in this clause covers demonstration, probable inference and practical postulate, so every argument must be graded on validity, soundness and adequacy separately.

01

STAGE 01 A PRIORI AND A POSTERIORI: CLASSIFY BY THE SOURCE OF THE PREMISES

A PRIORI = ONTOLOGICAL ONLY | A POSTERIORI = THE REST | SOURCE OF PREMISES, NOT MODALITY | NECESSITY vs EVIDENTIAL CONTACT | 2022 Q8(a), 20 MARKS | NYĀYA IS A POSTERIORI | WAY 4 IS A POSTERIORI

AXIS	A PRIORI	A POSTERIORI
Basis	the concept of God alone	observed features of the world
Example	ontological (Anselm, Descartes)	cosmological, teleological, moral, Nyāya
Strength	if valid, yields a necessary God	begins from premises the critic concedes
Weakness	existence is not a real predicate	a probable, finite, possibly plural cause

THE RULE THAT DECIDES EVERY CASE

- Classify by the source of the premises, never by the modality of the conclusion.
- Nyāya reaches an omniscient being and remains a posteriori, because invariable concomitance (vyāpti) must be fixed by observation.
- Aquinas' Fourth Way begins from observed degrees of goodness and truth, not from a concept of the maximum.

THE VERDICT FORMULA THE 2022 STEM WANTS

- Evidential contact favours a posteriori arguments.
- Modal strength favours the a priori route.
- Religious adequacy is delivered by neither alone, which is why the preference must name its criterion and pay its cost.

WHAT EACH SIDE LOSES

- A priori: Kant's charge that existence is not a real predicate.
- A posteriori: the conclusion reaches at best a probable, finite and possibly plural cause.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Preference is defensible only when the criterion is announced first and its cost is stated immediately afterwards.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A priori arguments reason from the concept of God alone, while a posteriori arguments reason from features of the world, and the division follows the premises rather than the conclusion.

02

STAGE 02 ONTOLOGICAL ARGUMENT: ANSELM'S TWO FORMS AND DESCARTES

PROSLOGION 2: REDUCTIO | PROSLOGION 3: NECESSARY EXISTENCE | ASEITY / SELF-EXISTENCE | DESCARTES, MEDITATIONS V | NOT MEDITATIONS III | GREATER = MORE PERFECT | 2018, 2020 AND 2024 STEMS

Define God as that than which nothing greater can be conceived → Assume existence in the understanding alone → Existing in reality is greater, so a greater is conceivable → Contradiction: therefore God exists in reality → Upgrade: inconceivable non-existence is greater, so God exists necessarily

THE DEFINITION AND WHY ITS WORDING MATTERS

- God is that than which nothing greater can be conceived; 'greater' means more perfect, never spatially larger.
- Anselm deliberately avoids 'the most perfect being that there is', which would be satisfied by whatever happens to be best.
- The argument is addressed to the fool who possesses the concept and is refuted out of his own understanding.

THE TWO FORMS SIDE BY SIDE

- Proslogion 2 concludes that God exists in reality as well as in the mind.
- Proslogion 3 concludes that God exists necessarily, because a being that cannot be thought not to exist is greater than one that can.
- The second form carries the whole reply to Gaunilo and every modern modal descendant.

DESCARTES' DIFFERENT MACHINERY

- Existence belongs to the essence of a supremely perfect being as three angles belong to a triangle, or a valley to a mountain.
- This is essence-containment, not Anselm's comparative reductio, and Kant's objection strikes it most directly.
- The causal proof from the idea of the infinite in Meditations III is a separate argument and must not be fused with it.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The second form changes the modal status of the conclusion, and an answer that omits it cannot make Anselm's reply to the island parody intelligible.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The ontological argument is an a priori attempt to derive God's necessary existence from the concept of the greatest conceivable being.

03

STAGE 03 ONTOLOGICAL CRITIQUE: GAUNILO, KANT AND THE MODAL REPAIR

GAUNILO: PERFECT ISLAND | KANT: NOT A REAL PREDICATE | HUNDRED THALERS | POSSIBILITY PREMISE | CONDITIONAL, NOT INSTANTIATION | NO INDIAN ANALOGUE | MALCOLM, HARTSHORNE, PLANTINGA

GAUNILO'S PARODY AND ANSELM'S REPLY

- Gaunilo wrote 'the most perfect of islands'; the parody is stronger if corrected to 'the most perfect conceivable island', and stating the correction shows real reading.
- Anselm answers that an island is a contingent piece of the physical world and can be thought not to exist, so the principle does not reach it.
- The reply protects the second form but transfers the burden to whether maximal greatness is coherent at all.

KANT'S DIAGNOSIS AND THE LOGICAL SEQUEL

- Existence is not a real or determining predicate: a hundred real thalers contain no more concept than a hundred possible thalers.
- Chatterjee and Datta restate the point in the Indian idiom of a hundred rupees imagined in one's pocket.
- On the post-Fregean analysis, 'exists' is a second-order quantificational notion and cannot appear among perfections at all.

THE MODAL REPAIR AND WHERE THE BURDEN LANDS

- If a maximally great being is possible, it exists necessarily in every possible world.
- A parallel possibility of non-existence yields the contrary conclusion by the same logic, so coherence must be argued independently.
- Verdict for 2018: the concept entails existence conditionally, never instantiation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Gaunilo offers a parody that the form proves too much, while Kant offers a diagnosis that the form uses existence illegitimately, and merging them loses both objections.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Conceptual analysis yields only a conditional, so the concept of God entails necessary existence hypothetically while never delivering instantiation.

04

STAGE 04 COSMOLOGICAL FAMILY: THREE FORMS AND TWO KINDS OF CAUSAL SERIES

AQUINAS: PRESENT DEPENDENCE | LEIBNIZ: SUFFICIENT REASON | KALĀM: TEMPORAL BEGINNING | PER SE vs PER ACCIDENS | HAND, STICK AND STONE | 'FIRST' IS EXPLANATORY | BEGINNING KNOWN BY FAITH

THREE FORMS THAT MUST NOT BE MERGED

- Aquinas argues from present change, ordered efficient causation and contingency to an unmoved actualiser, a first efficient cause and a necessary being.
- Leibniz argues from the contingent totality and the principle of sufficient reason to a necessary sufficient reason outside the series.
- The temporal-beginning argument makes an origin its explicit premise, and only it is hostage to cosmological findings about a first moment.

THE DISTINCTION THE WHOLE ARGUMENT TURNS ON

- An essentially ordered series acts simultaneously and its intermediates have only derivative power: remove the hand and the stick and stone stop at once.
- An accidentally ordered series runs grandfather to father to son, each member acting in its own right, and Aquinas need not terminate it.
- Therefore 'first' marks explanatory priority here and now, not the earliest event in time, and Aquinas holds a temporal beginning to be known by faith rather than proof.

WHAT THE CRITIC MUST BE ANSWERED ON

- Hume: why not an infinite series, and why must the cause be one, personal, infinite or good?
- Russell: the universe is just there, a brute fact, and the argument commits the fallacy of composition.
- Reply: the argument concerns dependence rather than property-transfer, but the brute fact option rejects sufficient reason instead of refuting the inference.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A critic who observes that the universe may be beginningless defeats only the temporal-beginning form, so the answer must name which form is under attack.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cosmological arguments differ in starting point and in what each must defend, and the decisive distinction is between essentially and accidentally ordered causal series.

05

STAGE 05 THE FIVE WAYS MAPPED, AND KANT'S ADEQUACY OBJECTION

WAY 1: CHANGE | WAY 2: EFFICIENT CAUSES | WAY 3: CONTINGENCY | WAY 4: DEGREES | WAY 5: DIRECTEDNESS | KANT: BORROWS THE ONTOLOGICAL | SUMMA THEOLOGIAE I q.2 a.3 | 2022 Q6(a), 20 MARKS

THE FIVE STARTING POINTS

- Way 1: change analysed as the actualisation of potential by something already actual.
- Way 2: ordered efficient causation, terminating in a first efficient cause.
- Way 3: things that come to be and pass away, terminating in a necessary being.
- Way 4: observed degrees of goodness, truth and nobility, terminating in a maximum.
- Way 5: regular goal-directed behaviour of things that lack knowledge of their end.

WHERE EACH WAY IS ATTACKED

- Way 3's weak steps are the quantifier shift at 'at some time nothing would have existed' and the passage from necessary-through-another to necessary-of-itself.
- Way 4 is defensible only through a metaphysics of participation.
- Kant's decisive charge is that the move from 'a necessary being' to 'the most real being' is the ontological argument in disguise.

HANDLING THE EVALUATIVE 2022 DEMAND

- Way 3 is defensible as the deepest question, provided the quantifier-shift objection is stated.
- Way 5 is defensible as the richest downstream tradition, provided Aquinas' regularity premise is separated from Paley's artefact analogy.
- Choosing Way 2 and describing it as 'the first cause who started the universe' loses marks, because that is not Aquinas' argument.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each Way closes with 'and this everyone understands to be God', which is precisely the identification that Kant's adequacy objection refuses to concede.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Five Ways are five distinct arguments with five distinct starting points, and merging them into a single temporal first-cause argument destroys the evaluative demand.

06

STAGE 06 THREE TELEOLOGIES THAT MUST NOT BE CONFUSED

WAY 5: ARCHER AND ARROW | PALEY: WATCH ON A HEATH | FINE-TUNING: CONSTANTS | GOVERNANCE, NOT ANALOGY | NATURAL THEOLOGY, 1802 | NEVER ATTRIBUTE THE WATCH TO AQUINAS | 2025 Q6(a), 20 MARKS

AQUINAS' FIFTH WAY

- The argument is from regular directedness in things that lack knowledge of their end.
- The illustration is the arrow that needs an archer, which is a governance claim rather than an inference from resemblance to machines.
- It is untouched by objections aimed at the artefact analogy.

PALEY'S ANALOGY AND ITS SUPPORT

- A watch found on a heath, whose wheels, cogs, axles, springs and balances are adjusted for regular timekeeping, obliges an intelligent maker; a stone does not.
- Three riders: the inference survives never having seen a watch made, imperfect working, and parts whose function we cannot discover.
- The evidence is cumulative: the eye as a self-adjusting optical instrument, the bird's wing, the fish's fin, planetary rotation and the seasons.

MODERN FINE-TUNING

- The contemporary argument is probabilistic and pre-biological, concerning the values of physical constants rather than adapted organisms.
- It abandons the artefact analogy altogether and therefore cannot be defended or attacked as if it were Paley's argument.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the objections differ for each form, an answer that fuses governance, analogy and probability invites a critique that lands on none of them precisely.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Design arguments come in three distinct forms, and the standard critique of one of them does not automatically transfer to the other two.

07

STAGE 07 HUME'S FIVE FRONTS, DARWIN'S EXACT SCOPE AND THE LIVE RIVALS

ADAPTED | ANALOGY | PROPORTION | PLURALITY | EVIL | PHILO, NOT CLEANTHES | DIALOGUES 1779 PRECEDE PALEY 1802 | DARWIN DOES NOT TOUCH FINE-TUNING

THE FIVE FRONTS, IN ORDER

- Any persisting universe must exhibit adaptation; the Epicurean hypothesis lets finite particles in random motion pass through every combination until one is stable.
- The universe resembles a vegetable or a crustacean at least as much as a machine, so the analogy is remote and the inference weak.
- Proportion cause to effect: a finite world never licenses an infinite creator.
- Many designers, an inferior, infant or senile deity, or an abandoned first attempt fit the evidence equally well.
- Disorder and suffering count against a good and powerful designer.

WHAT DARWIN ACTUALLY DEFEATS

- Random variation with differential survival explains biological adaptation, which was Paley's chosen evidence.
- Life fitted itself to the conditions, as the ozone illustration shows, rather than the conditions being fitted to life.
- It does not touch cosmic law-governedness or the fine-tuning of constants, which the mechanism itself presupposes.

THE RIVALS FINE-TUNING MUST BEAT

- Design; physical necessity; chance within a multiverse combined with an observation-selection effect; or an unknown deeper law.
- The argument is therefore inference to the best explanation, and a script that presents it as demonstration overstates the whole tradition.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Hume attacks inferential strength and the identity of the designer, so the correct verdict demotes the argument rather than declaring that no designer exists.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hume does not disprove a designer; he shows that the inference is weak and that its conclusion is underdetermined between rival designers.

08

STAGE 08 MORAL ARGUMENT: THREE ROUTES AND KANT'S TWO STOREYS

CONSCIENCE ROUTE (NEWMAN) | VALUE-GROUNDING ROUTE | KANT'S HIGHEST GOOD | FREEDOM, IMMORTALITY, GOD | OUGHT IMPLIES CAN | EUTHYPHRO MISSES KANT | 2021 Q7(b), 15 MARKS

Moral law obligates the highest good → Virtue and proportionate happiness cannot be united by finite agents → Ought implies can licenses postulation → Freedom, immortality and God are postulated → Rational faith: subjectively sufficient, objectively insufficient

THREE ROUTES, THREE DIFFERENT DEFEATS

- The conscience route infers a personal lawgiver from binding duty, and is pressed by naturalistic explanations of conscience; Hick adds that it begs the question.
- The value-grounding route infers a transcendent ground for stance-independent moral truths, and is pressed by the Euthyphro dilemma and by secular moral realism.
- Kant's route postulates rather than infers, and is pressed by the charge of projection and by the option of simply declining the postulate.

KANT'S STRUCTURE, STEP BY STEP

- The Critique of Pure Reason destroys the ontological, cosmological and physico-theological proofs.
- The moral law obligates pursuit of the highest good, in which virtue and proportionate happiness are united.
- Finite agents cannot secure that proportion and nature does not supply it, so 'ought implies can' licenses postulating its conditions.
- The three postulates are freedom, immortality and God, held as rational faith that is subjectively sufficient and objectively insufficient.

THE INDIAN COUNTERPART AND THE KEY CONTRAST

- Nyāya's fruit-giver allots the results of action as an intelligent moral governor.
- Kant postulates a God who could proportion virtue and happiness; Nyāya infers a God who does, which is epistemically bolder and correspondingly more exposed.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Euthyphro bears hardest on divine-command and value-grounding routes, and does not touch Kant, for whom the moral law is autonomous and God guarantees proportion rather than duty.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kant does not prove God through morality; he demolishes the theoretical proofs and then reinstates God as a postulate required for the possibility of the highest good.

09

STAGE 09 NYĀYA–UDAYANA: EIGHT COLLECTED GROUNDS AND THE UNSEEN-POTENCY ARGUMENT

EFFICIENT, NEVER MATERIAL CAUSE | KĀRYĀT AND ĀYOJANĀT | DHṚTYĀDEḤ | PADĀT, PRATYAYATAḤ, ŚRUTEḤ, VĀKYĀT | SAṂKHYĀVIŚEṢĀT | ADṚṢṬA NEEDS A SUPERINTENDENT | NYĀYAKUSUMĀÑJALI, 5th STABAKA | 2018, 2023 AND 2025 STEMS

THE LORD'S CAUSAL ROLE

- Īśvara is the first efficient and ordering cause, a builder rather than a maker from nothing; atoms, selves, space, time and ether are eternal and uncreated.
- He is also preserver and destroyer, and eternal intelligence is an inseparable attribute rather than his essence, which is the explicit contrast with Advaita.
- This is theism and not deism: the relation is continuous, and God is both the directive cause of human action and the dispenser of karmic fruit.

THE EIGHT GROUNDS, WITH ONE CLAUSE OF CONTENT EACH

- kāryāt: the composite world is an effect, being made of parts and of intermediate magnitude, so it presupposes an omniscient maker who can know atoms.
- āyojanāt: inert atoms cannot combine themselves, so the initial conjunction requires a conscious agent's volition.
- dhṛtyādeḥ: support, maintenance and periodic dissolution require a governing will.
- padāt, pratyayataḥ, śruteḥ and vākyāt: the transmission of language, the validity of the Veda, its testimony and its sentence-form each point to a personal author.
- saṃkhyāviśeṣāt: the first dyad requires the numerical cognition of a conscious being present at the start, and glosses of the last four grounds vary between commentators.

THE PHILOSOPHICAL CORE AND ITS PRESSURE

- Unseen moral potency is unconscious and cannot allot the right kind and degree of fruit to the right agent, so an omniscient superintendent is required.
- The circularity objection is answered by distinguishing the order of existence from the order of knowledge.
- Sharma's redundancy charge is the hardest: a God chained by the law of karma is reduced to a supervisor the system could have done without.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Udayana's grounds are offered as a collected case rather than as separate demonstrations, which is exactly why the leaky-bucket objection applies to him as much as to Swinburne.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya offers a rational, inferential theism in which the Lord is the omniscient efficient cause who orders eternal atoms and allots the fruits of action.

10

STAGE 10 FOUR INDIAN DENIALS, FOUR DIFFERENT PREMISES REJECTED

JAINA: MOTIVE ARGUMENT | BUDDHIST: KRAMA-AKRAMA | MĪMĀṂSĀ: APAURUṢEYA | CĀRVĀKA: NO INFERENCE | ADVAITA DEMOTES, NOT DENIES | GODHEAD WITHOUT GOD | DEVAS ARE NOT DENIED | 2018 Q8(b) AND 2019 Q5(e)

SCHOOL	PREMISE DENIED	POSITIVE DOCTRINE	NYĀYA'S REPLY
Jainism	that a perfect being could have a motive to create	divinity as the soul's achieved perfection; six eternal substances	unconscious karmic matter cannot allot determinate fruits
Buddhism	that a permanent cause can produce a temporal world	conditioned co-arising explains arising and cessation	the divine will is eternal, its effects timed by unseen potency
Mīmāṃsā	that scripture and ritual fruit need any author or dispenser	authorless Veda; self-fructifying unseen ritual potency	authorless normativity is itself unexplained
Cārvāka	that inference can reach the supersensible at all	perception alone; elements combine automatically	demanding perception begs the question against inference

THE TWO SENSES THAT SAVE THE ANSWER

- Sense A is the world-maker: the cosmological office of creating, sustaining, dissolving and allotting.
- Sense B is the perfected being: omniscient, passion-free, exemplary and non-creative.
- A school may deny Sense A completely and affirm Sense B completely, so denying a creator is not denying divinity.

THE HIGHEST-YIELD JAINA EXCHANGE

- A perfect being is complete and can have no motive to create, so either God is perfect and had no reason to act, or God had a reason and is not perfect.
- Classical theism replies that creation is a free, non-needy diffusion of goodness rather than the satisfaction of a lack.
- Every ford-maker becomes a liberated soul (siddha), but not every liberated soul was a ford-maker (tīrthaṅkara), and neither creates, judges nor answers prayer.

THE SHARPEST BUDDHIST ARGUMENT

- A permanent unchanging cause must produce all at once, collapsing the cosmos into one instant, or successively, which requires change in God.
- Nyāya answers that the divine will is eternal while its effects are timed by unseen potency; the Buddhist rejoins that a will timed by another is not the sole cause.
- Reducing the Buddhist case to the Buddha's silence surrenders the examinable argument.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each school denies a different premise of the Nyāya case, so treating them as one Indian atheism collapses four distinct objections into an unusable generalisation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian anti-creator arguments are economy moves, coherence moves or epistemic restrictions, and each targets a different premise of the inference to the Lord.

11

STAGE 11 CUMULATIVE-CASE LOGIC: ROPE, NOT CHAIN

C-INDUCTIVE | P-INDUCTIVE | SIMPLICITY AS PRIOR | MITCHELL'S JURY | FLEW'S TEN LEAKY BUCKETS | UNDERDETERMINATION SURVIVES | UDAYANA MADE THE SAME MOVE

THE TWO GRADES OF INDUCTIVE FORCE

- A C-inductive argument raises the probability of the conclusion without making it more probable than not.
- A P-inductive argument makes the conclusion more probable than not, and the whole programme is the passage from the first to the second.
- Swinburne adds a non-negligible prior from simplicity: one agent with infinite and therefore non-arbitrary degrees of power, knowledge and freedom.

THE IMAGES THAT DECIDE THE ANSWER

- The chain image is wrong, because the components are not deductions and there is no link to break.
- The rope image and Mitchell's jury of converging circumstantial evidence are the correct models.
- A cumulative case is also distinct from inference to the best explanation, which compares rival total hypotheses instead of accumulating confirmation.

THE STANDING OBJECTIONS

- Flew answers that stacked leaking buckets hold no more water, and zero plus zero is zero; the reply is that a C-inductive argument is not zero-valued by definition.
- Underdetermination survives: a finite designer, a committee of gods or an impersonal value-principle fit the same aggregated evidence.
- The case must be run as a net balance, with suffering counted on the other side.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Even a successful aggregation delivers a probability, and a probability does not by itself select the personal, morally perfect God of a living religion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: No single theistic argument is defended today as demonstrative, so the live claim is that several independently weak arguments jointly raise the probability of theism.

12

STAGE 12 COMPARATIVE BENCH, VERDICT LADDER AND THE ANSWER SPINE

BEING vs ORDER | FOUR DEFENSIBLE VERDICTS | CRITIQUE FROM INSIDE ORTHODOXY | NAME THE CRITERION | 10 / 15 / 20-MARK BANDS | TWELVE MASTER TRAPS | DIRECTIVE FIDELITY

Decode the directive → Reconstruct numbered premises → Attach each objection to its premise → Supply the proponent's best reply → Grade validity, soundness and adequacy; name the criterion

CONVERGENCE AND DIVERGENCE

- Both traditions build a posteriori inferences from order to intelligence.
- Aquinas' God causes being while Nyāya's Lord causes only order over eternal atoms, so convergence in form conceals divergence in content.
- Nyāya makes God the Veda's author while Mīmāṃsā makes the Veda authorless, a position with no Western analogue.
- Where the West's sharpest critics stood outside religion, India's stood inside it.

FOUR VERDICTS: CHOOSE ONE AND PAY ITS COST

- Minimal: no proof is demonstrative, each failing on validity, soundness or adequacy.
- Cumulative: individually weak, jointly they raise the probability of theism.
- Divergent: different proofs establish different things and none was meant to deliver the whole God of religion.
- Experiential: proofs are pleas offered in justification of faith, and God is known through direct experience.

THE ANSWER SPINE AND ITS BANDS

- Decode the directive, reconstruct numbered premises, attach each objection to the premise it attacks, give the best reply, then grade the verdict and name its criterion.
- Ten marks about 150 words; fifteen marks about 220 to 260; twenty marks about 320 to 360.
- Top-band discriminators: essentially versus accidentally ordered series, C- versus P-inductive force, ford-maker versus liberated soul, and the successive-or-simultaneous dilemma.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The proofs fail as demonstrations and succeed as diagnostics, which is why every tradition eventually supplements proof with experience, testimony or faith.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: No proof is demonstrative unless it survives validity, soundness and adequacy together, and every argument in this clause underdetermines the rich God of religion.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

MODAL LOGIC S5 DETAIL | BAYESIAN CONFIRMATION FORMALISM | ANTHROPIC REASONING VARIANTS | PARTICIPATION METAPHYSICS | REFORMED EPISTEMOLOGY | DIVINE-COMMAND VARIANTS

OPTIONAL ARGUMENTATIVE DEPTH

- Formal modal machinery behind the possibility premise, and the exact role of the characteristic axiom in Plantinga's reconstruction.
- Bayesian confirmation formalism, prior assignment and the independence condition that a cumulative case requires.

OPTIONAL COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Anthropic reasoning variants and the observation-selection literature that fine-tuning arguments must engage.
- Modified divine-command theories and the participation metaphysics that supports Aquinas' Fourth Way.

STATUS AND LIMIT

- None of this repairs a missing core premise, critic or verdict, and none of it is required by any of the twelve verified owner questions.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels